

Corporate Machiavelli Top Notes Of The Week

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CORPORATE MACHIAVELLI

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2026 America

Wealth Redistribution NOW || Violent Revolution LATER

These are the options.

Intense Inequality has side effects:

- Higher Homicide Rate (Inequality Drives Violence)
- Polarized Politics (Inequality Makes Politics More Intense)
- Violent Revolution / Civil War becomes more likely.

1788: France, Right Before Civil War,

Gini Coefficient: 50%

1963: Rhodesia / Zimbabwe, right before Civil War,

Gini Coefficient: 50%

2026 America,

Gini Coefficient 50%

Nothing to see here

Every society has a finite degree of inequality it can tolerate before collapsing from violent revolution.

2026 America is dangerously close to hitting this point.

If your solution to intense inequality is to tell the people at the bottom of the hierarchy "Inequality shouldn't bother you. It doesn't matter if others have more than you do!"

You are not offering a solution.

You are pretending the problem does not exist.

Signs You Are Being Deceived:

- Information that should be there, is not.
 - Information that is irrelevant is being emphasized.
 - Things that are simple are being presented as if they are complicated. Complexity is being manufactured out of nothing.
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High stress complex problem solving while in zero sum competition against adversaries who are intelligent and cunning.

Where will you find this?

- War
 - Politics
 - Business
-

Most people engage in zero critical thinking or rigorous logical reasoning. They operate off instinct and emotion.

Don't overestimate your competitors, or the targets of your manipulation.

When powerful people speak in public, they never use straight talk; they always use power talk.

They aren't saying what they actually think.

The masses don't realize this.

Insults should have zero impact on your psychological state.

Becoming angry when insulted is not a sign of strength; it's a sign of weakness.

If you are competent and charming, you thrive

If you are incompetent and charming, you survive.

If you are offensive or boring, and competent, you survive.

If you are neither competent nor charming, you die.

If someone feels you have wronged them, then apologize and make the apology seem genuine.

Whether or not you are actually sorry is irrelevant.

Don't apologize because you are sorry.

Apologize to increase the probability of them forgiving you.

Forgiveness can often be bought with nothing more than mere words.

Don't let your ego get in the way of buying forgiveness.

Free of charge.

Extroversion (enthusiasm) and IQ correlate negatively.

If you work in high end sales (say software sales, or medical device sales), you will probably disagree with this, since you work in a profession that actively selects for people who are both high IQ and extroversion.

If you encounter a man who is currently a loser, but who is working tirelessly and willing to take risks to improve his wretched life, help him out.

On the off chance that he succeeds, he will remember you forever.

Losers who are working like mad to become winners are the most undervalued high risk-high reward asset class in the universe.

Most high testosterone men have low or average IQs.

Most high IQ men are soy; they have low testosterone levels.

If you're a man with a high IQ, and high testosterone levels, you are exceptional.

People who have nothing to lose are rare.

Fools who think they have nothing to lose, but who actually have quite a bit to lose, are common.

Virtuous people are rare.

Monsters who appear virtuous because they are expert virtue signallers are common.

The gap between rich and poor is astronomical.

A billionaire makes more money in a minute, than a poor person will in their entire lifetime.

It is astronomically better to be powerful, rather than powerless.

When playing the game of power, it is impossible to overestimate how high the stakes are.

Revolution is what happens when young men with high testosterone levels come to the conclusion that they would rather die in combat, than continue living under the status quo.

If you have a deep voice, and you speak slowly, this causes people to perceive that you are authoritative and credible; someone whose opinion should be taken seriously.

Politics = Propaganda wars

Each side trying to shift the Overton Window in their favor.

A good relationship is effortless, a bad relationship is endless work.

This is true business relationships, romantic relationships, and friendships.

To win the respect of intelligent people, display intelligence and wisdom.

To win the respect of dumb and average people, display a high stress tolerance and a capacity for ruthlessness.

Notice the word 'capacity'.

Not ruthless all the time for no reason, but rather wielding such a capacity for those occasions when it is needed.

What holds you back are usually not the assets you lack, but rather liabilities you continue to hold on to because you've deceived yourself into believing you need them.

These liabilities are often people.

Make the accusation come as a surprise, and they're less likely to be capable of preparing a plausible lie in time to respond.

Lure the target into a false sense of security... then ambush.

Fools cannot be reasoned with.

They can only be manipulated.

Emotional person cannot be reasoned with.

They can easily be manipulated.

Naive:

- Trying to argue with an idiot. Trying to get him to believe the truth.
- Saying what you actually think
- Criticizing your superiors directly
- Complaining about your own problems

Cunning:

- Telling people what they want to hear
- Calculating your words, and modifying them as the situation requires
- Hide your displeasure, fake your contentment. Avoid criticizing those above you, and if some criticism is necessary deliver it as gently and indirectly as possible.

- Don't talk about your own problems. Talk about their problems and appear sympathetic.
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If you can't succeed as an employee, the probability you will succeed as an entrepreneur is practically zero.

The demands that entrepreneurship places on Intelligence, **Cunning**, Energy, and Stress Tolerance

are FAR GREATER

than the demands placed on a employee.

Worldly Wealth and Wisdom are entirel distinct things, with a correlation of zero.

At age 34, Robert Greene had no wordly wealth (was broke), but had immense wisdom (48 Laws)

At age 60, Felix Dennis has both worldly wealth and wisdom (How To Get Rich)

Refer to your girlfriend/wife as 'Woman', and your relationship will run more smoothly.

CLASS WARFARE:

Both the rich and the poor benefit from free markets.

Besides that, the interests of the rich and the interests of the poor are usually in zero sum conflict.

What is good for the rich?

Low wages and no minimum wage. To the rich, wages represent labor costs.

Zero wealth redistribution (so the rich don't have to pay taxes to fund the wealth redistribution)

What is good for the poor?

High wages and a minimum wage that is generous. To the poor, wages represent income.

Generous wealth redistribution, funded by high taxes on the rich.

"Success is worth any price..." - Illimitable Man

Power is worth any price.

Confidence is calm.

Narcissism is neurotic.

Confident people are calm on the outside and calm on the inside.

Narcissists are arrogant on the outside, and insecure on the inside.

For a man to live a fulfilled life, he must satiate his ambition.

For a woman to live a fulfilled life, she must satiate her hypergamy.

A man lives a fulfilled life by making something of himself.

A woman lives a fulfilled life by marrying such a man, and conceiving children with him.

Law 21

If You Are A Predator, Pose As A HousePet

Make your target think you are ineffectual, timid perhaps even a bit naive.

Ensure they perceive you are a bit timid, and a bit naive... until it's already too late.

Women want a man who has a capacity for ruthlessness, but they don't want a man who is ruthless all the time for no reason.

Women want to sheepdog, not wolf.

They want a man who is disagreeable enough such that he will be capable of protecting her.

They don't want a man who is so disagreeable that he will abuse her and abuse the children.

This is the difference between an integrated shadow, and an out of control shadow.

Not being able to relate to most people sounds like a bad thing, but it is not.

Most people achieve nothing significant in their entire life.

...Why would you want to be able to relate to them?

"CM, you should advise politicians on how to win elections."

I do

"Can you name people who you have helped win elections?"

NO I cannot name names.

I would sooner die than violate a client's privacy.

Machiavellianism, Studying What Matters:

3 Most important venues for the game of power, in modern America:

- Job Interviews
- Office Politics
- Sales/Marketing

Why?

These venues are where the money is made.

2 most important Machiavellian social competences, in modern America:

- Cold Reading / Analytical Mind

- Charm

Master these 5 things, and that is 99% of what you will need to know about cunning for the modern environment.

I have never run for political office.

I have put people in political office.

Low IQ + High Cunning =

- Dealing Drugs

- Running low level simple scams to steal small sums from poor people

High IQ + High Cunning =

- Manipulating elections

- Buying media outlets to distribute propoganda

- Executing complex scams to steal huge sums from rich people (see 'The Yellow Kid' / Joseph Weil) (See Jordan Belfort)

- Insider trading

- Market Manipulation

- Cornering the market for a certain product and then raising prices

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When playing the game of power, it is impossible to overestimate how high the stakes are.

If you know a person who wants to move alone to a cabin in the woods, and spend their days reading and writing, while have a subsistence level of material wealth

...That person probably has an IQ of 140+

People with 'normal' IQ's (say in the range of 80-120) aren't interested in that sort of thing.

An IQ of 130 is the bridge between normal people (IQs around 100), and socially awkward geniuses (140+).

At 130, you are smart enough to talk to geniuses and understand what they are sayingm, but also dumb enough to be able to relate to people with IQs of 100 and not be hopelessly socially awkward around them.

Revolution is what happens when young men with high testosterone levels come to the conclusion that they would rather die in combat, than continue living under the status quo.

God cannot change the past.

A decent lawyer can.

Law 30 Addendum:

To do a thing is difficult.

To do a thing, and make it look easy, is even more difficult.

If you see a person carry out a task, and they make it look easy, you are witnessing mastery.

If a person's advice boils down to "Work hard, take lottery style bets, and hope you get lucky just like I did."

They aren't giving you advice.

They are giving you a suicide mission.

I consider advising someone to become an entrepreneur to be monstrously irresponsible

Why?

when you tell someone to become an entrepreneur, you are essentially telling them to enter financial equivalent of the Hunger Games.

Yes, there is a small and significant chance they could get rich. The overwhelming statistical probability is they will fail and be far poorer than if they simply kept their day job.

“The lower the IQ, the higher the drama.

The lower the testosterone, the higher the drama.

The higher the ego, the higher the drama.

These general trends I’ve observed.” - Illimitable Man

Who manufactures conflict out of nothing?

- Dumb People (low IQ)
- Women and low testosterone men (low testosterone)
- Narcissistic men (high ego)

Who doesn’t manufacture conflict out of nothing?

- Smart men with high testosterone levels, who do NOT have narcissistic personality disorder.
 - Psychopathic men (who aren’t narcissistic)
 - Autistic men
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If someone is talking a lot and saying nothing, distrust them.

There’s a couple possibilities...

1. They're dumb. A low IQ idiot who can't string a coherent sentence together. Incompetent.
2. They want to maintain the pretense that they've answered your question, without actually giving out the information you're looking for.

This is what politicians do.

3. They are intentionally obscuring information, by using unnecessarily complicated language that nobody can understand.

Example: Lawyers using legalese, to hide information that they're obligated to tell you, but that they don't actually want you to be aware of.

4. They are using unnecessarily complicated language, an obnoxious writing style, to show off how smart they are.

Example: Academics writing research papers.

Law 27 Addendum:

If someone promises you things that sound positive, but the promises are vague, chances are their promises are empty.

If a person speaks in terms that are vague, don't trust them.

Either they are hiding something (lawyers and politicians), or they don't know anything but want to sound like they know what they're talking about (management consultants).

P.S. If these notes changed how you think about reputation, truth, friendship, power, and perception, *55 Essays by Corporate Machiavelli*

continues the study.

You will get 55 essays on hierarchy, cunning, office politics, persuasion, status, relationships, deception, and the incentives hidden beneath human behavior — along with more than 10,000 deleted tweets and private audio interviews from the CM .

[Study the complete archive here](#)
